

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 612

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to propose an amendment to Article II, Section 7, and Article VII, Section 5 of the Constitution of Tennessee, to provide the General Assembly authority to set the dates of elections.

WHEREAS, Tennessee's voter turnout each year routinely trails most other states; and

WHEREAS, increasing voter turnout in this State is of critical importance to ensure that the people are represented by officials who most closely align with the beliefs and needs of a majority of their constituents; and

WHEREAS, the General Assembly finds that ensuring that State and local officials are elected by a majority rather than a plurality is beneficial to this State and, therefore, to the United States; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that a majority of all the members of each house concurring, as shown by the yeas and nays entered on their journals, that it is proposed that Article II, Section 7 of the Constitution of the State of Tennessee be amended by deleting the section and substituting instead:

Sec. 7. Time of elections.

The first election for Senators and Representatives shall be held on the second Tuesday in November, one thousand eight hundred and seventy; and forever thereafter, elections for members of the General Assembly shall be held once in two years, on such dates and in such manner as the Legislature shall direct.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a majority of all the members of each house concurring, as shown by the yeas and nays entered on their journals, that it is proposed that

Article VII, Section 5 of the Constitution of the State of Tennessee be amended by deleting the first sentence of the section and substituting instead:

Elections for Judicial and other civil officers shall be held on the first Thursday in August, one thousand eight hundred and seventy, and forever thereafter on such dates and in such manner as the Legislature shall direct next preceding the expiration of their respective terms of service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the foregoing amendment be referred to the One Hundred Fifteenth General Assembly and that this resolution proposing such amendment be published by the Secretary of State in accordance with Article XI, Section 3 of the Constitution of Tennessee by posting such amendment on the official website of the Secretary of State and on the official website of the General Assembly.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Clerk of the Senate is directed to deliver copies of this resolution to the Secretary of State, with this final resolving clause being deleted from such copies.